PAKISTAN & THE WORLD / DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

Friday, 30 October 2026 | Issue No. 11

LEAD REPORT / ECONOMY

Pakistan’s fiscal surplus narrows as interest costs rise The Finance Division reported stronger tax receipts but a smaller fiscal buffer during the opening months of FY27.

On Thursday, 29 October 2026, Pakistan’s Finance Tax collection offered a more positive signal. FBR Division released its October Monthly Economic collections reached Rs3,086.2 billion in July– Update & Outlook, showing that the overall fiscal September FY27, exceeding target by Rs33.2 surplus for the reported opening fiscal period had billion. The document also placed the current narrowed to Rs1,197.9 billion, or 0.8 per cent of account deficit at $874 million for that quarter, with GDP, against Rs2,123.8 billion, or 1.7 per cent, in the workers’ remittances up 14 per cent to $10.9 billion. comparable period a year earlier. According to the The distinction between revenue performance and report, mark-up payments increased by 36.6 per fiscal space is central to evaluating public finances. cent while development expenditure rose 69.5 per Higher debt-service costs can reduce room for cent. Non-interest expenditure declined by 8.1 per development, even when tax receipts exceed cent, largely reflecting a 90 per cent reduction in targets. The official report described continuing subsidies. The primary surplus declined from 2.3 to macroeconomic stability, while its figures show a 1.6 per cent of GDP. smaller surplus than a year earlier.

BACKGROUND / An overall fiscal balance includes interest costs; a primary balance excludes them. Positive balances can coexist with pressure from debt servicing or higher spending. REVISION 01 Overall surplus: 0.8% of GDP, against 1.7% a year before. 02 Mark-up payments rose 36.6%; FBR collections reached Rs3,086.2bn. 03 Current account deficit: $874m in July–September FY27. EXAM ANGLE Current Affairs / Pakistan Affairs — fiscal consolidation, public debt and macroeconomic resilience SOURCES [1] [2]

AT A GLANCE

01 Public finances 02 Khunjerab trade Debt-service spending grew while the reported fiscal Pakistani and Chinese customs officials agreed to speed surplus narrowed. up eligible farm consignments. 03 Judicial verdict 04 Euro-area policy An anti-terrorism court imposed ten-year sentences on The ECB kept interest rates unchanged and announced a two lawyers. leadership transition. 05 Ecosystem restoration UN agencies counted 252 million hectares under restoration worldwide.

CSS VISTA / NATIONAL AFFAIRS

01 Pakistan INDICATOR STRIP / LATEST AVAILABLE BEFORE ISSUE

SBP POLICY RATE KSE-100 CLOSE 12.00% / 26 Oct 2026 167,193.44 / 29 Oct 2026

As of 26 Oct (SBP rate) and 29 Oct (KSE-100). Policy rate | Market close

BILATERAL TRADE

Pakistan and China agree on Khunjerab green channel Priority handling of eligible agricultural shipments is intended to reduce delays at the mountainous crossing.

On Thursday, 29 October 2026, the customs administrations of Pakistan and China signed an online agreement to operationalise a green channel at the Sost–Khunjerab border for agreed agricultural and related products. The Pakistani side was led by FBR Member Customs (Operations) Syed Shakeel Shah, while the Chinese delegation represented Urumqi and Tashkurgan Customs.

The arrangement envisages priority processing and examination for eligible consignments, including perishables, while retaining risk-based customs controls. Both administrations also agreed to exchange information and customs risk alerts. These provisions are meant to improve clearance rather than dispense with inspection.

The Khunjerab crossing connects Gilgit-Baltistan with China’s Xinjiang region. Snow and difficult mountain conditions have historically restricted winter movement, giving faster treatment of time- sensitive goods particular importance.

BACKGROUND Customs green channels are facilitation arrangements. They should be distinguished from tariff exemptions or unrestricted entry of goods.

ANALYSIS Trade facilitation can lower delays and spoilage in agricultural exports, but actual gains depend on the agreed product list, border operations, inspection capacity and road reliability. The agreement also illustrates the practical, non- infrastructure dimension of Pakistan–China economic relations.

THREE REVISION POINTS 01 The agreement was signed on 29 October by the two customs administrations. 02 It covers an agreed list of agricultural and allied products. 03 Priority clearance remains subject to risk-based controls. EXAM ANGLE Pakistan Affairs / International Relations — Pakistan–China trade and border connectivity SOURCES [3] [4]

REGIONAL DIPLOMACY

Prime minister links Turkish ties with regional diplomacy Shehbaz Sharif emphasized defence cooperation alongside dialogue at an Islamabad ceremony.

On Thursday, 29 October 2026, Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif addressed a ceremony in Islamabad marking Türkiye's 103rd national day. He said Pakistan and Türkiye would continue to promote dialogue, diplomacy and peaceful settlement of disputes while strengthening defence cooperation.

The prime minister referred to the Makkah Defence Agreement involving Pakistan, Türkiye and Saudi Arabia, which he said had been signed on 7 August. He presented the arrangement as part of cooperation designed to support deterrence and regional stability. His remarks were made during an extended period of conflict and diplomatic activity in the Middle East.

The address placed defence partnerships and respect for international law together, rather than depicting military links as a substitute for diplomacy. It also showed the continuing importance Islamabad attaches to Ankara as a regional partner.

BACKGROUND Pakistan and Türkiye maintain ties across diplomacy, defence and economic cooperation. The national-day setting was the occasion for the 29 October remarks.

ANALYSIS For foreign-policy analysis, a state can pursue deterrence and negotiation at the same time. The practical question is whether cooperation produces crisis-management channels and measurable regional stability, beyond political declarations.

THREE REVISION POINTS 01 The speech took place in Islamabad on 29 October. 02 It marked Türkiye's 103rd national day. 03 The prime minister linked defence cooperation with dialogue and international law. EXAM ANGLE International Relations — regional alignments, deterrence and conflict resolution SOURCES [5] [6]

LAW AND RIGHTS

Anti-terrorism court sentences two rights lawyers to ten years The defence challenged aspects of the proceedings; rights groups raised due-process concerns.

On Thursday, 29 October 2026, an anti-terrorism court sentenced human rights lawyers Imaan Zainab Mazari-Hazir and Hadi Ali Chattha to ten years' imprisonment each in a security-breach case. Judge Tahir Abbas Sipra delivered the verdict in proceedings at Adiala Jail.

The prosecution alleged that the pair interfered with security arrangements related to an international cricket team's movement during an incident in 2024. Both defendants pleaded not guilty. The case involved allegations under terrorism and criminal-law provisions, and the defence had challenged the proceedings before superior courts.

Amnesty International criticized the convictions on 29 October, saying the proceedings had not met fair-trial standards. Its criticism represents the rights organization's assessment, not a court finding.

The prosecution and the court’s verdict represent separate legal positions, and the convictions may be subject to further judicial review.

BACKGROUND Anti-terrorism courts adjudicate offences assigned to them by law. The existence of an anti-terrorism charge does not by itself settle debate about due process or the merits of an appeal.

ANALYSIS The case raises questions about the appropriate scope of exceptional criminal procedures, defendants’ access to counsel and appellate safeguards. Legal analysis should separate the court’s findings, the prosecution’s allegations and the defence’s arguments.

THREE REVISION POINTS 01 The verdict was delivered on 29 October 2026 at Adiala Jail. 02 Each defendant received a ten-year term in the reported case. 03 Amnesty International publicly challenged the trial’s fairness. EXAM ANGLE Pakistan Affairs / Governance — criminal justice, fair trial and judicial oversight SOURCES [7] [8]

FINANCIAL INCLUSION

State Bank launches single financing portal for smaller firms SMEConnect is intended to centralize financing applications submitted to banks and development finance institutions.

On Thursday, 29 October 2026, the State Bank of Pakistan announced the launch of SMEConnect, a centralized digital portal for small and medium enterprises seeking financing from banks and development finance institutions.

The central bank directed that, from 1 November 2026, applications for SME financing should pass through the portal, including applications initiated by customers visiting bank branches or banking websites. The arrangement is designed to make the application process more visible and consistent across participating institutions.

According to the central bank’s announcement reported by Dawn, the system would allow tracking of applications and provide a dashboard displaying the status of financing requests, approvals, rejections and disbursements. The measure changes the application channel; it does not guarantee loan approval.

BACKGROUND SMEs often face information, documentation and collateral barriers in formal credit markets. Digital submission does not remove credit-risk assessment.

ANALYSIS The portal’s success will depend on user accessibility, data protection, clear rejection reasons and banks’ willingness to lend. Monitoring approvals and disbursements, not merely portal registrations, will provide a stronger test of financial inclusion.

THREE REVISION POINTS 01 SMEConnect was launched on 29 October. 02 The mandatory application channel was scheduled for 1 November. 03 A centralized portal is not itself a credit guarantee. EXAM ANGLE Economy / Governance — SME finance, digitization and regulatory reform SOURCES [9] [10]

PROVINCIAL POLITICS

PTI restates support for Sohail Afridi in KP A party notification addressed speculation over its choice of provincial chief minister amid governor’s rule.

On Thursday, 29 October 2026, Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf issued a notification reaffirming that Sohail Afridi remained its nominated chief minister in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa. Party chairman Barrister Gohar Ali Khan said the decision rested with party founder Imran Khan and told party representatives not to initiate discussions on replacing Afridi.

The statement followed uncertainty after the federal government imposed governor’s rule in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa earlier in October. Afridi was described in reporting as non-functional following that intervention. The 29 October notification was a statement of the party’s position, rather than a judicial resolution of the constitutional questions surrounding the province.

The development highlighted the interaction between party command, provincial institutions and federal emergency arrangements.

BACKGROUND Governor’s rule places the operation of provincial institutions within a constitutionally sensitive federal–provincial framework. Party nominations and legal officeholding should be distinguished.

ANALYSIS A governance analysis should examine lawful authority, institutional continuity, legislative accountability and judicial review. The event is chiefly significant as a political position issued during a contested administrative situation.

THREE REVISION POINTS 01 The party notification was issued on 29 October. 02 PTI reaffirmed Sohail Afridi as its preferred KP chief minister. 03 The statement followed governor’s rule imposed earlier in October. EXAM ANGLE Political Science / Pakistan Affairs — federalism and provincial autonomy SOURCES [11] [12]

CSS VISTA / INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

02 World EUROPEAN INSTITUTIONS

Lagarde announces early departure from European Central Bank The ECB president will leave in February 2027, ahead of the scheduled end of her term.

On Thursday, 29 October 2026, the European Central Bank announced that its president, Christine Lagarde, would step down on 7 February 2027. The statement said Lagarde had notified the ECB Governing Council and European Council President António Costa.

The change brings forward the leadership transition from the end of her scheduled October 2027 term. The ECB said the next president would be appointed by the European Council under Article 283 of the Treaty on the Functioning of the European Union.

In subsequent remarks reported by Reuters, Lagarde linked her decision to a wish to speak more freely about matters beyond monetary policy. The timing coincides with a difficult inflation outlook shaped by elevated energy prices.

BACKGROUND The ECB is the central bank for the euro area. Its president chairs the Governing Council, while appointment follows an EU treaty process.

ANALYSIS Central-bank independence depends on both formal safeguards and public confidence in continuity. Succession arrangements matter because financial markets judge whether the institution’s inflation mandate will remain credible through leadership change.

THREE REVISION POINTS 01 The ECB announcement was dated 29 October 2026. 02 Lagarde’s announced departure date is 7 February 2027. 03 Article 283 TFEU governs the appointment process. EXAM ANGLE International Relations / Economy — EU institutions and central-bank independence SOURCES [13] [14]

MONETARY POLICY

ECB holds rates amid mounting energy-price pressures The euro-area central bank maintained its three principal rates and warned of risks to inflation and growth.

On Thursday, 29 October 2026, the European Central Bank kept its three key interest rates unchanged. The deposit facility rate remained 2.50 per cent, the main refinancing rate 2.65 per cent and the marginal lending facility rate 2.90 per cent.

In its decision, the Governing Council said rising energy prices presented upward risks to inflation and downward risks to economic growth. It also noted tighter financing conditions and said it would continue to use incoming data and a meeting-by-meeting approach rather than committing in advance to a rate path.

The bank reiterated its aim of stabilizing inflation at 2 per cent over the medium term. The decision came as the euro area faced higher energy costs linked to the Middle East conflict.

BACKGROUND A central bank sets short-term policy rates to influence financing conditions, economic demand and inflation expectations. The three ECB rates serve different money-market functions.

ANALYSIS Holding rates is not the same as removing inflation concern. Policymakers must weigh supply-driven price increases against slower output, especially when interest rates cannot directly produce more energy.

THREE REVISION POINTS 01 Deposit facility: 2.50%; main refinancing: 2.65%. 02 Marginal lending facility: 2.90%. 03 The ECB retains a 2% medium-term inflation target. EXAM ANGLE Economy / International Relations — monetary policy, inflation and supply shocks SOURCES [15]

MIDDLE EAST | HUMANITARIAN SECURITY

Taiz governor warns of famine as Yemen violence continues Aid access and claims about an airstrike highlighted competing accounts of a severe humanitarian emergency.

On Thursday, 29 October 2026, authorities in Yemen reported that a Saudi airstrike in western Taiz had killed at least 13 people. The death toll was attributed by the Associated Press to the Houthi-run health ministry; it was not presented as an independently established count.

Taiz Governor Nabil Shamsan said the city was experiencing famine and described acute shortages of water, fuel, flour and medical oxygen. The World Food Programme said it could not reach more than 600,000 people reliant on assistance. The governor said the city held roughly one million residents.

Houthi leader Abdul Malik al-Houthi denied that the city was under siege and said routes remained open for humanitarian supplies. Human Rights Watch argued that using starvation as a method of warfare could amount to a war crime. These statements reflect opposing claims about access and responsibility.

BACKGROUND Taiz has been contested during Yemen’s civil war since 2014. Government forces hold the city centre, while Houthi forces control surrounding routes, according to AP reporting.

ANALYSIS The episode illustrates why civilian access, independent monitoring and protection of humanitarian operations are central questions under international humanitarian law. Claims of famine, access restrictions and attack attribution require careful sourcing.

THREE REVISION POINTS 01 Taiz is a major contested city in Yemen. 02 WFP said more than 600,000 aid-dependent people were unreachable. 03 The Houthi leadership disputed the description of a siege. EXAM ANGLE International Relations / Current Affairs — Yemen conflict and humanitarian law SOURCES [16] [17]

ENVIRONMENT | UN REPORT

UN records 252 million hectares under ecosystem restoration A new global stocktake identifies large-scale recovery efforts but a substantial gap before 2030.

On Thursday, 29 October 2026, the FAO, UNEP and Convention on Biological Diversity secretariat released a joint assessment reporting 252 million hectares under restoration across 149 countries. The report linked the recorded activities with more than one million green jobs.

The organizations said annual restoration financing would have to more than quadruple to reach existing commitments by 2030. They identified slower progress in freshwater, marine and coastal ecosystems, even as some terrestrial efforts expanded.

The findings were presented at the UN Biodiversity Conference in Yerevan, Armenia, during the UN Decade on Ecosystem Restoration, which runs from 2021 to 2030. The long-term pledges include restoration at a scale of about one billion hectares, while the Kunming–Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework has its own target for degraded ecosystems.

BACKGROUND Restoration aims to assist degraded ecosystems in recovering their structure, biodiversity and ecological functions. Under restoration does not necessarily mean fully recovered.

ANALYSIS Reporting a large area under restoration is progress, but outcomes also depend on ecological condition, durability and monitoring. Finance shortfalls and weak coverage of coastal systems show why hectares alone are not enough to measure success.

THREE REVISION POINTS 01 252 million hectares were reported under restoration. 02 The stocktake covered 149 countries. 03 Annual restoration finance must more than quadruple, the report said. EXAM ANGLE Environmental Science / Current Affairs — ecosystem restoration and biodiversity finance SOURCES [18] [19]

GLOBAL BIODIVERSITY DIPLOMACY

COP17 negotiators struggle over finance and marine biodiversity Delegates in Yerevan worked through disputed provisions ahead of the biodiversity conference’s closing day.

On Thursday, 29 October 2026, delegates at the seventeenth Conference of the Parties to the Convention on Biological Diversity continued negotiations in Yerevan, Armenia, with unresolved issues concerning resource mobilization, marine biodiversity and participation of Indigenous peoples and local communities.

The Earth Negotiations Bulletin reported debates over references to the new agreement on biodiversity beyond national jurisdiction, descriptions of ecologically or biologically significant marine areas, forest-biodiversity work and the terms of international cooperation. Several provisions remained in square brackets, signalling that agreement had not yet been reached.

Working groups also considered arrangements for scientific cooperation and implementation of the Kunming–Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework. Delegations disagreed on some institutional wording, leaving decisions for further negotiation.

BACKGROUND COP17 is the seventeenth meeting of parties to the Convention on Biological Diversity, not the UN climate COP31. The two treaty processes have different mandates.

ANALYSIS The debate is a case study in environmental multilateralism: states may agree on broad conservation goals while contesting financing, legal references and the distribution of obligations. Final agreed wording, not draft language, determines treaty-body decisions.

THREE REVISION POINTS 01 COP17 talks were held in Yerevan, Armenia. 02 Resource mobilization and marine biodiversity remained disputed. 03 Bracketed text indicates language without consensus. EXAM ANGLE Environmental Science / International Relations — biodiversity governance and treaty negotiations SOURCES [20] [21]

NEXT SEVEN DAYS 1 November SMEConnect becomes the required channel for SME financing applications to Pakistani banks and DFIs. SOURCES [10]

2 November UN global commemoration against impunity for crimes against journalists and launch of UNESCO Director-General’s report. SOURCES [27]

3 November United States regular federal general election. SOURCES [28]

4–6 November 45th UN/CEFACT Forum on trade facilitation and digital trade, Geneva. SOURCES [29]

CSS VISTA / DAILY REVISION

03 General Knowledge 18 FACTS / VERIFIED IN THE LISTED SOURCES 01 ECONOMY The Finance Division reported an overall fiscal surplus of 0.8% of GDP in the period reviewed. [1]

02 ECONOMY The corresponding earlier-period overall surplus was 1.7% of GDP. [1]

03 ECONOMY Mark-up payments increased 36.6% in the ministry’s reported period. [1]

04 REVENUE FBR collected Rs3,086.2bn during July–September FY27. [1]

05 EXTERNAL Pakistan’s July–September FY27 current account deficit was $874m. [1]

06 EXTERNAL Workers’ remittances totalled $10.9bn in July–September FY27. [1]

07 TRADE The Sost–Khunjerab arrangement targets agreed agricultural and allied goods. [4]

08 DIPLOMACY The 29 October Islamabad ceremony marked Türkiye’s 103rd national day. [5]

09 JUSTICE Imaan Mazari-Hazir and Hadi Chattha each received a ten-year term on 29 October. [7]

10 FINANCE SMEConnect was announced as the centralized application portal for SME loans. [10]

11 PROVINCES PTI issued a notification backing Sohail Afridi on 29 October. [11]

12 EUROPE The ECB announced Lagarde would leave on 7 February 2027. [13]

13 EU LAW Article 283 TFEU is cited by the ECB for appointment of its president. [13]

14 BANKING The ECB deposit-facility rate stayed at 2.50% on 29 October. [15]

15 BANKING The ECB marginal-lending-facility rate stayed at 2.90%. [15]

16 CONFLICT WFP said it could not reach over 600,000 aid-dependent people in Taiz. [16]

17 ECOLOGY The UN restoration stocktake identified 252 million hectares across 149 states. [18]

18 ECOLOGY The UN Decade on Ecosystem Restoration covers 2021–2030. [18]

CSS VISTA / REFERENCE LEXICON

04 Five Terms CONSTITUTION AND POLITICAL SCIENCE

Bicameralism A bicameral legislature has two chambers rather than one. The two chambers participate in lawmaking under rules that differ between constitutions. WHY IT MATTERS It affects representation, scrutiny and the balance between territorial and population-based interests. EXAMPLE United Kingdom: the House of Commons and House of Lords share legislative work under the UK parliamentary system. REFERENCE UK Parliament, Bicameral system INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AND DIPLOMACY

Non-refoulement Non-refoulement is the rule against returning a refugee to a place where serious threats to life or freedom await. It is a core protection in Article 33 of the 1951 Refugee Convention, subject to the treaty’s legal framework. WHY IT MATTERS It is fundamental to asylum policy and international protection obligations. EXAMPLE The 1951 Convention placed the principle in Article 33; the 1967 Protocol later broadened the refugee regime. REFERENCE UK Home Office, Article 33 of the 1951 Refugee Convention ECONOMY AND PUBLIC FINANCE

Gini index The Gini index measures inequality in the distribution of income or consumption. On the World Bank’s 0–100 scale, zero expresses perfect equality and 100 expresses perfect inequality. WHY IT MATTERS It helps compare distributional outcomes alongside growth and poverty figures. EXAMPLE World Bank World Development Indicators publishes the Gini index as indicator SI.POV.GINI. REFERENCE World Bank, Gini index metadata LAW, GOVERNANCE AND PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

Delegated legislation Delegated legislation is law made under authority that primary legislation confers on a minister or another authorized body. Statutory instruments are a common form and remain subject to the parent statute and relevant scrutiny procedures. WHY IT MATTERS It tests the separation of powers, administrative flexibility and parliamentary control. EXAMPLE United Kingdom: statutory instruments operate under powers granted by Acts of Parliament. REFERENCE UK Parliament, Secondary legislation ENVIRONMENT AND SCIENCE

Ecological succession Ecological succession is change in ecological communities over time following colonization or disturbance. The path depends on surviving organisms, soils, disturbance and chance rather than a single fixed sequence. WHY IT MATTERS It explains ecosystem recovery and informs restoration and conservation planning. EXAMPLE Mount St. Helens: recovery after the 18 May 1980 eruption has been documented by the US Geological Survey. REFERENCE USGS, Ecological succession at Mount St. Helens

CSS VISTA / KNOWLEDGE CHECK

05 Practice 15 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS

01 According to the October Finance Division update, the reported overall surplus was what share of GDP?

A. 0.8% B. 1.6% C. 2.3% D. 3.7%

02 Which agency signed the green-channel arrangement with the Chinese customs side?

A. Pakistan Railways B. Pakistan Customs C. Pakistan Ports Authority D. State Bank of Pakistan

03 Where did Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif address the Turkish national-day event?

A. Ankara B. Lahore C. Islamabad D. Istanbul

04 Which institution delivered the 29 October security-breach verdict?

A. Election Commission B. Federal Shariat Court C. Supreme Court D. Anti-terrorism court

05 What is the name of the central bank’s new SME application platform?

A. SMEConnect B. TradePass C. CreditGate D. FinanceBridge

06 Which provincial politician received renewed support in PTI’s notification?

A. Ali Amin Gandapur B. Sohail Afridi C. Mahmood Khan D. Pervez Khattak

07 What date did the ECB announce for Lagarde’s departure?

A. 31 December 2026 B. 1 January 2027 C. 7 February 2027 D. 31 October 2027

08 Which ECB policy rate was maintained at 2.90%?

A. Deposit facility B. Main refinancing C. Bank reserve rate D. Marginal lending facility

09 Which city was the subject of the 29 October famine warning?

A. Taiz B. Aden C. Sanaa D. Hodeidah

10 How many countries were included in the UN restoration stocktake?

A. 129 B. 149 C. 169 D. 189

11 Where did COP17 biodiversity talks take place?

A. Bonn B. Geneva C. Yerevan D. Nairobi

12 Which three-month period was used for the reported FY27 FBR collection?

A. January–March B. April–June C. October–December D. July–September

13 A parliament with two legislative chambers is described as what?

A. Bicameral B. Confederal C. Unicameral D. Presidential

14 Which instrument contains the refugee principle of non-refoulement in Article 33?

A. UN Charter B. 1951 Refugee Convention C. Vienna Diplomatic Convention D. Convention on the Law of the Sea

15 On the World Bank’s 0–100 scale, a Gini index of zero means what?

A. Maximum inequality B. Moderate inequality C. Perfect equality D. Unknown distribution

CSS VISTA / PRACTICE SOLUTIONS

Answer Key 01 A The ministry recorded an overall surplus of 0.8% of GDP. Source

02 B The agreement was concluded between the two customs administrations. Source

03 C The 29 October ceremony took place in Islamabad. Source

04 D An anti-terrorism court delivered the ten-year sentences. Source

05 A The SBP named the new platform SMEConnect. Source

06 B The 29 October party notification backed Sohail Afridi. Source

07 C The ECB specified 7 February 2027. Source

08 D The marginal lending facility was kept at 2.90%. Source

09 A The warning concerned Taiz, Yemen. Source

10 B The report counted restoration activity in 149 countries. Source

11 C Delegations negotiated in Yerevan, Armenia. Source

12 D The Finance Division stated collections for July–September FY27. Source

13 A Bicameralism means a two-chamber legislature. Source

14 B The 1951 Refugee Convention establishes the principle in Article 33. Source

15 C Zero is the theoretical endpoint of perfect equality. Source

CSS VISTA / SOURCE REGISTER

06 References NUMBERED REFERENCE BIBLIOGRAPHY 01 Finance Division, Monthly Economic Update & Outlook, October 2026

02 Dawn, 29 Oct 2026, Fiscal position in early FY27

03 Pakistan Press Information Department, 29 Oct 2026, green-channel agreement

04 Dawn, 29 Oct 2026, Sost-Khunjerab customs agreement

05 Dawn, 29 Oct 2026, Pakistan-Türkiye diplomacy

06 Radio Pakistan, 30 Oct 2026, report of 29 Oct Türkiye reception

07 Dawn, 29 Oct 2026, ATC verdict on Mazari and Chattha

08 Amnesty International, 29 Oct 2026, Fair-trial concerns

09 SBP, 29 Oct 2026, SMEConnect Circular No. 08

10 Dawn, 30 Oct 2026, SMEConnect launch on 29 Oct

11 Dawn, 29 Oct 2026, PTI supports Sohail Afridi

12 Express Tribune, 29 Oct 2026, party notification about Afridi

13 European Central Bank, 29 Oct 2026, President to depart

14 Reuters, 29 Oct 2026, Lagarde decision

15 European Central Bank, 29 Oct 2026, Monetary policy decisions

16 Associated Press, 29 Oct 2026, Taiz famine and airstrike

17 Human Rights Watch, 29 Oct 2026, Taiz humanitarian crisis

18 FAO, 29 Oct 2026, Global restoration stocktake

19 UN in Indonesia, 29 Oct 2026, Restoration Progress Report

20 IISD, 29 Oct 2026, CBD COP17 negotiations

21 Convention on Biological Diversity, 29 Oct 2026, COP17 high-level segment

22 UK Parliament, Bicameral system

23 UK Home Office, Article 33 of the 1951 Refugee Convention

24 World Bank, Gini index metadata

25 UK Parliament, Secondary legislation

26 USGS, Ecological succession at Mount St. Helens

27 UNESCO, 2 November 2026, Day to End Impunity for Journalists

28 US Federal Election Commission, General election date

29 UN Geneva, UN/CEFACT Forum, 4–6 Nov

30 Dawn, 26 Oct 2026, SBP policy rate decision

31 Dawn, 30 Oct 2026, KSE-100 close of 29 Oct